If you now open your web browser and navigate to https://localhost:9999/natter.html you'll see the familiar Natter Create Space form. Because the port is different and Natter API requests violate the SOP, this will be treated as a separate origin by the browser, so any attempt to create a space or login will be rejected, with a cryptic error message in the JavaScript console about being blocked by CORS policy (figure 5.1). You can fix this by adding CORS headers to the API responses to explicitly allow some cross-origin requests.

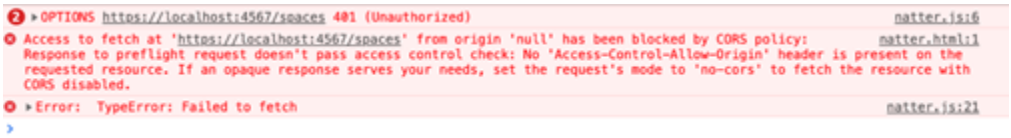


Figure 5.1 An example of a CORS error when trying to make a cross-origin request that violates the same-origin policy.

5.1.1 Preflight requests

Before CORS, browsers blocked requests that violated the SOP. Now, the browser makes a *preflight request* to ask the server of the target origin whether the request should be allowed, as shown in figure 5.2.

> **DEFINITION** A ***preflight request*** occurs when a browser would normally block the request for violating the same-origin policy. The browser makes a HTTP OPTIONS request to the server asking if the request should be allowed. The server can either deny the